

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-700-STEP Supportive Services
	Document No./Name	P-710-STEP Supportive Services
	Effective Date	January 1, 2021

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

Participants are provided supportive services to enable them to participate in the STEP Program.

Supportive services may also be provided to:

- FITAP recipients participating in approved activities necessary to meet exemptions to the FITAP time limits,
- FITAP recipients participating in the FITAP Drug Testing Program,
- FITAP recipients participating in approved activities when they are exempt from the participation rate calculations, or
- FITAP recipients participating in non-countable activities (refer to [P-420-STEP](#), section P-428).

Supportive services payments are made to participants through direct deposit to the client's bank account (checking or savings) or payments to a Stored Value Card account.

Before the *** STEP Coach** can enter authorization of direct payments to participants, written verification of expenses must be provided.

Direct advance payment or reimbursement may be made to the participant for the purchase of these services if it is determined that they are essential for STEP participation or to accept or maintain employment.

The **STEP Coach** may reduce, close, or deny in whole or in part an individual's request for a support service payment if a need is not demonstrated or the purpose for the payment is not related to the individual's Family Success Agreement.

The participant must provide verification from the provider of the need and anticipated cost before payment can be made.

Approval of advance payments can be made only with the concurrence of the **STEP Supervisor**.

II. PROCEDURES

The **STEP Coach **** shall inform the participant of available supportive services as part of the initial family assessment and shall integrate the provision of any necessary supportive services into the Family Success Agreement ([STEP 6](#)), ******* developed and signed by the participant.

To be eligible for reimbursement, supportive services other than child care must be approved by the *** STEP Coach **** no later than the 10th day after the supportive services begin. The participant must provide verification from the service provider before payment can be made.

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Exception: When a FITAP application is certified, supportive services may be provided for the entire month of FITAP application, regardless of when the supportive services began or when the FITAP application is certified.

There are no provisions for routine issuance of parish payments in STEP. All * STEP payments are issued through the LITE Payment System.

Supportive services provided or claimed for reimbursement must be reasonably related to the hours of participation.

Reimbursement of support services must be issued within 10 days of receipt of verification.

The STEP Coach must terminate ongoing supportive services payment authorizations prior to STEP referral closure in LITE **. ***

The participant must be notified by form STEP 12 within 10 days of all supportive services payments initially authorized or subsequently changed.

The participant must be notified by form STEP 12 within 10 days of the initial authorization of the transportation stipend and at case closure for the termination of the stipend. If an overpayment exists as a result of an administrative error, recovery should be initiated.

The * STEP Coach must coordinate supportive services with related services provided by other agencies.

Once advance payment is authorized, the client must provide the receipt of the expense within 10 days as stated on the STEP 12. A copy of the receipt should be saved in OnBase and the original returned to the participant. If a receipt is not provided within 10 days as requested, the STEP Coach is to complete form STEP 20 to obtain repayment. If the participant requests additional time to provide the receipt, document Person Notes allowing extra time to provide the receipt, but within thirty days of authorization.

After an advance payment has been made based on the verified anticipated cost, the STEP Coach must verify the actual cost. If the anticipated cost was greater than the actual cost, the STEP Coach is to initiate recovery for the difference. The participant must provide a personal check, business check, or money order to the parish office. A form STEP 20 must then be completed describing the circumstances of the overpayment. The check or money order, made payable to DCFS, must be attached to the form STEP 20 and forwarded to the ES Fraud and Recovery Unit. If the participant does not refund the overpayment, a referral must be made to the ES ** Fraud and Recovery Unit.

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
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If the anticipated cost was less than the actual cost, the * STEP Coach ** must take action within 10 days to issue a supplemental payment.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

[STEP 6 Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Family Success Agreement

[STEP 12 Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Notice of Action-Transportation and Other Supportive Services

[STEP 20 Form](#) / [Instructions](#) Claim Determination Report

IV. REFERENCES

[LAC 67:III.5729](#)

P.L. 104–193